

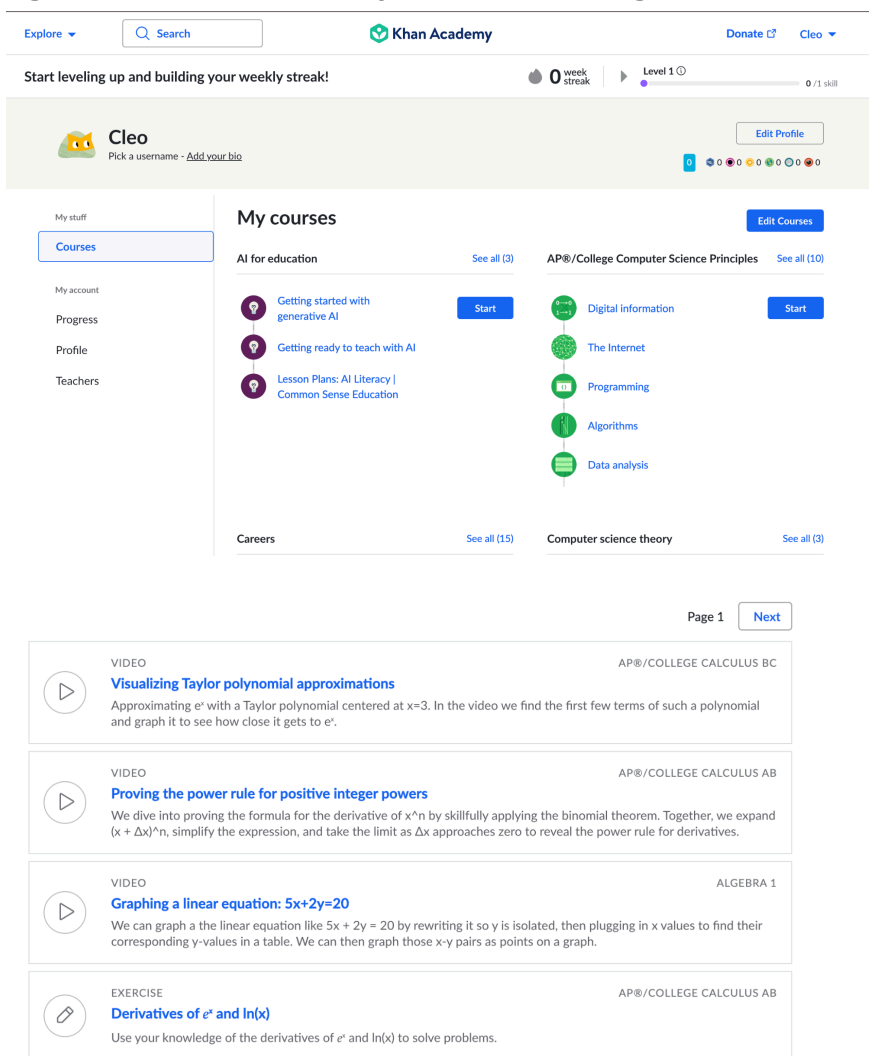
Group Design B: UX Research Report

Subject: Khan Academy Course Catalogue

1. Introduction

This report evaluates the **Khan Academy course catalogue** as a reference for the design of the SkillUp course catalogue. The evaluation focuses on how easily users can search, browse and interact with courses. The evaluation uses the **Shortened User Experience Questionnaire (UEQ-S)** and considers **Fitts's Law**, particularly the size, spacing and positioning of interactive elements.

Figure 1. Khan Academy course catalogue



Source: KhanAcademy, “My courses page”&”Course search page”, 2026.

2. Method

The evaluation involved trying to find a specific course, “**Get Ready for Algebra 1**”, using Khan Academy's search and catalogue. The interface was also browsed without using search to observe how easily courses could be discovered.

The experience was rated using the eight UEQ-S dimensions, from **-3 to +3**, based on the observed interaction.

3. UEQ-S Results

English version		
obstructive	o o o o o ● o	supportive
complicated	o o o o o ● o	easy
inefficient	o o o o o ● o	efficient
confusing	o o o o o ● o	clear
boring	o o ● o o o o	exciting
not interesting	o o ● o o o o	interesting
conventional	o o o o ● o o	inventive
usual	o o o o o ● o	leading edge

UEQ-S Dimension	Score	Observation
Obstructive - Supportive	+2	The search function makes it easy to find a specific course.
Confusing - Clear	+2	Categories of subjects and headings are understandable, although they do not stand out strongly.
Complicated - Easy	+2	Course result areas and buttons are large and easy to click.
Inefficient - Efficient	+2	Searching is quick, although browsing requires more scrolling.
Boring - Interesting	-1	The catalogue looks clean but does not strongly encourage exploration.
Not interesting - Exciting	-1	The interface does not make discovering new subjects particularly exciting.
Conventional - Inventive	+1	The platform feels like a learning platform but uses a layout that is not completely familiar.
Usual - Leading Edge	+2	The interface feels modern and current.

4. Fitts's Law

Fitts's Law explains how the size, distance and positioning of a target affect how quickly a user can interact with it. Khan Academy performs well in this area because its interactive elements are generally large enough to select easily.

The course results provide a large clickable area rather than requiring users to click on a small piece of text. The search bar and buttons are also easy to locate and interact with. There is enough spacing between the filters to prevent accidental selections.

However, the spacing between course items is less noticeable. The courses remain easy to select, but the catalogue could use clearer separation between items to improve scanning.

These observations support the SkillUp requirement for **large, clearly separated interaction areas** rather than small clickable elements.

5. Design Implications for SkillUp

The Khan Academy evaluation provides several useful design considerations for SkillUp.

First, the course catalogue should use a **traditional list layout** with clearly separated courses. This supports the client's requirement for an informative and searchable catalogue.

Second, the entire course row could act as a clickable target. This would provide a larger interaction area and support **Fitts's Law**.

Third, SkillUp should provide a **prominent search function** because searching was significantly faster than browsing when the required course was already known.

Fourth, SkillUp should include **sorting options** such as difficulty, duration, popularity or date. This would allow users to organise the course list according to their needs instead of relying only on the order in which courses are displayed.

Finally, filters should remain clearly separated and easy to interact with. Categories can reduce the number of courses shown at once while still allowing users to browse when they are unsure of exactly what they want.

6. Conclusion

The Khan Academy evaluation shows that a course catalogue can remain simple while still providing an efficient user experience. Its search function makes finding a known course easy, while large interactive areas support quick selection. However, the catalogue provides limited motivation to explore unfamiliar subjects.

For SkillUp, the findings support a **searchable, sortable list layout** with large clickable course rows, clear spacing and easily accessible filters. This approach meets the client's preference for an informative catalogue while applying Fitts's Law to make interaction efficient.